



7-13-2021 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dh9lwYBIDxE
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Board/Body: Muncie Community Schools (MCS) Board of School Trustees

Meeting Date: July 20, 2021

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Dr. Neil called the regular meeting to order at 5:00 PM.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. Neil (President), Mrs. Bales, Mrs. Barns Griffin, Mr. Webb, Dr. Krakowski (Superintendent).
 - **Members Absent:** Mr. Heater (attempted to call in).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Dr. Neil.

3. Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - The board observed a moment of silence in remembrance of Chad Clevenger, a School Resource Officer (SRO) recently killed in a motorcycle accident.
 - Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript).*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:14:30 Textbook Fees Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Reynolds presented the elementary, middle school, and high school textbook fees for board approval. Key changes included reducing overall fee counts by maintaining social studies adoptions at the elementary level, utilizing federal grants to cover and reduce costs for Muncie Area Career Center (MAC) resources, introducing a low \$5 middle school textbook fee via classroom set sharing, minor price increases for updated Cambridge Latin and Advanced Placement textbooks to meet College Board requirements, and pausing secondary English adoptions due to COVID-19 travel disruptions.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:18:45 2021-2022 School Year Lunch Prices**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome / Chartwells partner.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the annual school lunch price update. For the third consecutive year, the community feeding plan will provide breakfast and lunch at **no charge** for all elementary, middle, and high school students. Adult staff and guest meal prices will see an increase, while a la carte prices remain unchanged.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Motion by Dr. Neil, Second by Mrs. Bales).
- **00:20:02 Financial Report (June 2021)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome reviewed the financial results and cash balances for June 2021, noting that the snapshot sets baseline funds ahead of the upcoming 18-month budget cycle presented next month. The district successfully made scheduled debt payments of \$2.5 million in June. The overall cash balance closed at approximately \$31 million (slightly up from January), an education fund surplus is anticipated by year-end, and the state school loan balance stands down to \$11.4 million.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:10:27 Rick Yancer (Former newsman and author)**
 - **Topics Addressed:** Addressed rumors regarding Muncie Community Schools "taking in" the YMCA, questioning the use of public land and public funds for a

- “members-only” and “pay-to-play” group.
 - **Board Response:** Dr. Neil and board members clarified that MCS is not taking in the YMCA, but rather engaging in a preliminary joint venture with an independent entity<U+2014>a common practice in Indiana public schools (such as Westfield) utilizing no public tax funds for the partnership itself.
- **00:31:42 Rick Yancer (Second Speaker Turn)**
 - **Topics Addressed:** Followed up to clarify hiring difficulties regarding support staff versus teachers, and inquired about debt types carried by the school corporation (bonds vs. state loans).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
 - **Superintendent Updates (00:04:49):**
 - Upcoming “Fan Fest” at Southside with the Lieutenant Governor and Meridian Health offering physicals and vaccinations.
 - Expanded registration pushes, including days at the central building, secondary schools (July 16), elementary schools (July 23), special registration evenings (July 28<U+2013>30), and a new registration booth at the Delaware County Fair (evenings 4:00 PM <U+2013> 9:00 PM).
 - “Kickoff to Kindergarten” scheduled for July 26<U+2013>30.
 - Return to normal bell schedules for elementary and middle schools (7-period days), with high schools shifting to a block schedule.
 - Reopening recommendations will be presented at the second meeting in July. Masks are optional for vaccinated individuals.
 - **Staff Introductions (00:27:58):** Cindy Miller was introduced as a new administrative team member joining from Colorado Springs.
 - **Tributes & Memorials (00:28:42):** The board honored the life and legacy of Charles McPeck, a long-time Muncie educator (30 years across Garfield, Claypool, and Longfellow) and social justice advocate who passed away on July 5th.
 - **Upcoming Events:** Muncie Central marching band contest on July 24th featuring 22 bands.
- **Adjournment:** Official adjournment by voice vote.